

CALM KIDS

A Mindfulness & Meditation Guide for Children (Ages 6-12)

15 Chapters * Guided Scripts * Activities * 30-Day Challenge

By Daniel Tesfamariam

CALM KIDS: A Mindfulness & Meditation Guide

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

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CHAPTER 1

What Is Mindfulness?

Mindfulness means paying attention to the present moment on purpose, without judgment. It means noticing what is happening RIGHT NOW - what you see, hear, feel, and think - without trying to change it. Your mind naturally wanders to the past (worrying about what happened) or future (worrying about what might happen). Mindfulness brings you back to NOW, where life actually happens. It is a skill anyone can learn with practice!

CHAPTER 1: PRACTICE

GUIDED PRACTICE (Read Slowly):

Sit still for 1 minute. Just breathe and notice. What do you hear? What do you feel? Where does your mind wander? Gently bring attention back to your breath each time. That's mindfulness!

YOUR ACTIVITY:

Draw or list 5 things you notice right now using your senses.

JOURNAL REFLECTION:

How do I feel before practicing? _____

How do I feel after practicing? _____

What did I notice? _____

DRAWING/COLORING SPACE:

Draw how you feel after mindfulness practice

CHAPTER 2

Mindful Breathing (5 Techniques)

Your breath is always with you - it is the easiest mindfulness anchor. When you focus on breathing, your nervous system calms down, your heart rate slows, and your brain gets more oxygen. Here are 5 breathing techniques: 1) Belly Breathing (hand on belly, breathe so it rises), 2) 4-7-8 Breathing (in 4, hold 7, out 8), 3) Box Breathing (in 4, hold 4, out 4, hold 4), 4) Bunny Breathing (3 quick sniffs in, 1 long out), 5) Flower & Candle (smell flower in, blow candle out).

CHAPTER 2: PRACTICE

GUIDED PRACTICE (Read Slowly):

Choose one technique. Practice it 3 times right now. In through nose for 4 counts, hold for 4 counts, out through mouth for 6 counts. Notice how you feel before and after.

YOUR ACTIVITY:

Which breathing technique is your favorite? Practice it 3 times today.

JOURNAL REFLECTION:

How do I feel before practicing? _____

How do I feel after practicing? _____

What did I notice? _____

DRAWING/COLORING SPACE:

Draw how you feel after mindfulness practice

CHAPTER 3

Body Scan for Kids

A body scan means slowly paying attention to each part of your body, from toes to head. You notice how each part feels without trying to change anything. Does your forehead feel tight? Are your shoulders up by your ears? Is your tummy relaxed? A body scan helps you find where you hold stress and tension, and gently release it.

CHAPTER 3: PRACTICE

GUIDED PRACTICE (Read Slowly):

Lie down comfortably. Close your eyes. Start at your toes - wiggle them, then relax. Move to feet, ankles, shins, knees... all the way up to the top of your head. Spend 5 seconds on each area.

YOUR ACTIVITY:

Color in a body outline showing where you feel tense (red) vs relaxed (blue).

JOURNAL REFLECTION:

How do I feel before practicing? _____

How do I feel after practicing? _____

What did I notice? _____

DRAWING/COLORING SPACE:

Draw how you feel after mindfulness practice

CHAPTER 4

Mindful Eating

How often do you eat while watching TV, playing games, or rushing? Mindful eating means paying full attention to your food. Notice its colors, smell it, feel its texture, chew slowly, and taste every flavor. When you eat mindfully, you enjoy food MORE, eat the right amount (your body tells you when it is full), and feel more satisfied afterward.

CHAPTER 4: PRACTICE

GUIDED PRACTICE (Read Slowly):

Take ONE raisin (or any small food). Look at it closely for 30 seconds. Smell it. Put it on your tongue without chewing. Notice the flavor. Chew slowly - 20 chews! Notice how the taste changes.

YOUR ACTIVITY:

At your next meal, eat the first 5 bites mindfully - no talking, no screens, full attention.

JOURNAL REFLECTION:

How do I feel before practicing? _____

How do I feel after practicing? _____

What did I notice? _____

DRAWING/COLORING SPACE:

Draw how you feel after mindfulness practice

CHAPTER 5

Mindful Walking

You walk every day but rarely NOTICE it. Mindful walking means paying attention to each step: how your feet feel hitting the ground, the sensation of movement, the air on your skin, and the world around you. Walking mindfully can be done anywhere - on the way to school, in a hallway, or in nature. It's a great way to calm down and feel grounded.

CHAPTER 5: PRACTICE

GUIDED PRACTICE (Read Slowly):

Walk very slowly for 1 minute. Feel your heel touch down, then your toes.

Notice weight shifting. Feel your legs move. Look around as if seeing everything for the first time.

YOUR ACTIVITY:

Take a 5-minute mindful walk today. Count your steps. What did you notice?

JOURNAL REFLECTION:

How do I feel before practicing? _____

How do I feel after practicing? _____

What did I notice? _____

DRAWING/COLORING SPACE:

Draw how you feel after mindfulness practice

CHAPTER 6

5 Senses Grounding

When you feel overwhelmed, anxious, or scattered, use your 5 senses to come back to the present moment. This technique is called 5-4-3-2-1 Grounding: Notice 5 things you can SEE, 4 things you can TOUCH, 3 things you can HEAR, 2 things you can SMELL, 1 thing you can TASTE. By the time you finish, your mind has returned to the present.

CHAPTER 6: PRACTICE

GUIDED PRACTICE (Read Slowly):

Right now, try it: Name 5 things you see. Touch 4 different textures near you. Listen for 3 sounds. Find 2 smells. Notice 1 taste in your mouth. How do you feel now?

YOUR ACTIVITY:

Practice 5-4-3-2-1 grounding when you feel worried or overwhelmed today.

JOURNAL REFLECTION:

How do I feel before practicing? _____

How do I feel after practicing? _____

What did I notice? _____

DRAWING/COLORING SPACE:

Draw how you feel after mindfulness practice

CHAPTER 7

Dealing with Worry Mindfully

Everyone worries sometimes. But worry is about the FUTURE - things that haven't happened (and usually won't!). Mindfulness helps with worry by bringing you back to the present, where you are safe. Instead of fighting worry or pushing it away, mindfulness teaches you to NOTICE it, name it ('Oh, that's worry'), and let it pass like a cloud in the sky.

CHAPTER 7: PRACTICE

GUIDED PRACTICE (Read Slowly):

Imagine your thoughts are clouds floating across the sky. You are the sky - vast and calm. Worries are just clouds passing through. Watch them come... and go... without grabbing onto them.

YOUR ACTIVITY:

Next time you worry, try 'thought clouds' - watch the worry float by without grabbing it.

JOURNAL REFLECTION:

How do I feel before practicing? _____

How do I feel after practicing? _____

What did I notice? _____

DRAWING/COLORING SPACE:

Draw how you feel after mindfulness practice

CHAPTER 8

Anger Management Through Mindfulness

Anger is energy! It is not bad - but it needs to be expressed safely.

Mindfulness helps with anger by creating a PAUSE between the trigger and your reaction. In that pause, you can choose a response instead of reacting impulsively. Notice anger in your body first: hot face, tight jaw, clenched fists. Name it: 'I feel angry.' Then choose your response.

CHAPTER 8: PRACTICE

GUIDED PRACTICE (Read Slowly):

STOP technique: S-Stop what you're doing. T-Take 3 deep breaths. O-Observe what you're feeling. P-Proceed with a wise choice. Practice this before anger peaks.

YOUR ACTIVITY:

Think of your last angry moment. Where did you feel it in your body? What triggered it?

JOURNAL REFLECTION:

How do I feel before practicing? _____

How do I feel after practicing? _____

What did I notice? _____

DRAWING/COLORING SPACE:

Draw how you feel after mindfulness practice

CHAPTER 9

Bedtime Relaxation

Many kids struggle to fall asleep because their minds race with thoughts. Bedtime mindfulness helps your body and mind wind down. Progressive muscle relaxation (tense then release each muscle group), body scans, counting breaths, and peaceful visualization all help signal to your brain: it's time to sleep. A calm mind leads to better sleep.

CHAPTER 9: PRACTICE

GUIDED PRACTICE (Read Slowly):

Lie in bed. Squeeze your toes tight for 5 seconds, then release. Move up: calves, thighs, belly, chest, arms, hands, face. Squeeze tight, then let go. Feel yourself melting into the bed.

YOUR ACTIVITY:

Tonight, try progressive muscle relaxation before sleep. Rate your sleep quality tomorrow.

JOURNAL REFLECTION:

How do I feel before practicing? _____

How do I feel after practicing? _____

What did I notice? _____

DRAWING/COLORING SPACE:

Draw how you feel after mindfulness practice

CHAPTER 10

Gratitude Practice

Gratitude means noticing and appreciating what is GOOD in your life.

Research shows grateful people are happier, healthier, and sleep better!

Mindful gratitude means really FEELING thankful, not just listing things.

When you appreciate something, pause and let the warm feeling fill you up.

It rewires your brain to notice more positive things.

CHAPTER 10: PRACTICE

GUIDED PRACTICE (Read Slowly):

Close your eyes. Think of someone you love. Picture their face. Feel the warmth of love and gratitude for them. Let that feeling expand in your chest. Stay with it for 1 minute.

YOUR ACTIVITY:

Write 3 things you're grateful for. But for each one, also write WHY and how it FEELS.

JOURNAL REFLECTION:

How do I feel before practicing? _____

How do I feel after practicing? _____

What did I notice? _____

DRAWING/COLORING SPACE:

Draw how you feel after mindfulness practice

CHAPTER 11

Loving-Kindness Meditation

Loving-kindness meditation involves silently sending good wishes to yourself and others. You repeat phrases like 'May I be happy. May I be safe. May I be healthy. May I live with ease.' Then you extend these wishes to loved ones, friends, difficult people, and eventually all beings. This practice increases empathy, reduces anger, and builds compassion.

CHAPTER 11: PRACTICE

GUIDED PRACTICE (Read Slowly):

Sit quietly. Say to yourself: 'May I be happy. May I be peaceful. May I be safe.' Feel it. Now think of someone you love: 'May they be happy. May they be peaceful. May they be safe.'

YOUR ACTIVITY:

Send loving-kindness wishes to 3 people today: yourself, a friend, and someone you find difficult.

JOURNAL REFLECTION:

How do I feel before practicing? _____

How do I feel after practicing? _____

What did I notice? _____

DRAWING/COLORING SPACE:

Draw how you feel after mindfulness practice

CHAPTER 12

Mindful Movement (Yoga Poses)

Yoga combines movement, breathing, and mindfulness into one practice. Simple poses help you connect body and mind, build strength and flexibility, and find calm. Key poses for kids: Mountain Pose (standing tall), Tree Pose (balance on one foot), Child's Pose (rest), Cat-Cow (spine stretch), Warrior (strength), and Corpse Pose (total relaxation).

CHAPTER 12: PRACTICE

GUIDED PRACTICE (Read Slowly):

Try Mountain Pose: Stand tall, feet together, arms at sides. Feel your feet on the ground. Imagine a string pulling the top of your head toward the sky. Breathe 5 times. Feel strong and centered.

YOUR ACTIVITY:

Try 3 yoga poses and hold each for 5 breaths. Notice how your body and mind feel after.

JOURNAL REFLECTION:

How do I feel before practicing? _____

How do I feel after practicing? _____

What did I notice? _____

DRAWING/COLORING SPACE:

Draw how you feel after mindfulness practice

CHAPTER 13

Nature Mindfulness

Nature is the perfect place to practice mindfulness because it engages all your senses. The sounds of birds, the feel of wind, the smell of grass, the sight of colors - nature pulls you into the present moment naturally. Research shows that spending time mindfully in nature reduces stress hormones, boosts immunity, and improves mood significantly.

CHAPTER 13: PRACTICE

GUIDED PRACTICE (Read Slowly):

Sit outside quietly for 5 minutes. Don't use any device. Just BE in nature.

What sounds do you hear? What do you smell? What do you feel on your skin?

What colors do you see?

YOUR ACTIVITY:

Take a mindful nature walk this week. Collect 5 natural items and describe each with 3 words.

JOURNAL REFLECTION:

How do I feel before practicing? _____

How do I feel after practicing? _____

What did I notice? _____

DRAWING/COLORING SPACE:

Draw how you feel after mindfulness practice

CHAPTER 14

Mindfulness at School

School can be stressful: tests, social situations, busy schedules. But mindfulness can help everywhere - even at your desk! Try: 3 deep breaths before a test. Mindful listening in class. Feeling your feet on the floor when anxious. One-minute breathing breaks between classes. Noticing without judgment when your mind wanders.

CHAPTER 14: PRACTICE

GUIDED PRACTICE (Read Slowly):

Before your next test, try this: Close eyes, take 3 deep breaths, say 'I am prepared and calm,' open eyes. This reduces test anxiety and improves focus.

YOUR ACTIVITY:

Practice 3 mindful breaths before each class tomorrow. Notice any difference in focus.

JOURNAL REFLECTION:

How do I feel before practicing? _____

How do I feel after practicing? _____

What did I notice? _____

DRAWING/COLORING SPACE:

Draw how you feel after mindfulness practice

CHAPTER 15

30-Day Mindfulness Challenge

You now have all the tools for a mindful life! This 30-day challenge gives you one simple practice per day. Remember: mindfulness is a SKILL - it gets easier with practice. Some days will be hard and your mind will wander a LOT. That is normal and okay! The practice is NOTICING the wandering and gently coming back. Every time you notice, you get stronger.

CHAPTER 15: PRACTICE

GUIDED PRACTICE (Read Slowly):

Commit to just 5 minutes per day for 30 days. That's all it takes to build a life-changing habit. Mark each day you practice. Be kind to yourself on days you forget.

YOUR ACTIVITY:

Start Day 1 today! Set a daily reminder. Tell someone about your challenge for accountability.

JOURNAL REFLECTION:

How do I feel before practicing? _____

How do I feel after practicing? _____

What did I notice? _____

DRAWING/COLORING SPACE:

Draw how you feel after mindfulness practice

30-DAY MINDFULNESS CHALLENGE

- Day 1: ☐ 1 min belly breathing Feeling after: _____
- Day 2: ☐ Body scan (head to toe) Feeling after: _____
- Day 3: ☐ Mindful eating (1 bite) Feeling after: _____
- Day 4: ☐ 5-4-3-2-1 grounding Feeling after: _____
- Day 5: ☐ 3 gratitude items Feeling after: _____
- Day 6: ☐ Mindful walking (2 min) Feeling after: _____
- Day 7: ☐ Cloud watching (thoughts) Feeling after: _____
- Day 8: ☐ Loving-kindness (self) Feeling after: _____
- Day 9: ☐ Nature sit (5 min) Feeling after: _____
- Day 10: ☐ Mindful listening (1 min) Feeling after: _____
- Day 11: ☐ Box breathing (5 rounds) Feeling after: _____
- Day 12: ☐ Progressive relaxation Feeling after: _____
- Day 13: ☐ Mindful coloring Feeling after: _____
- Day 14: ☐ Count 10 breaths Feeling after: _____
- Day 15: ☐ Gratitude letter Feeling after: _____
- Day 16: ☐ Yoga poses (5 min) Feeling after: _____
- Day 17: ☐ Mindful shower Feeling after: _____
- Day 18: ☐ Loving-kindness (friend) Feeling after: _____
- Day 19: ☐ Worry cloud exercise Feeling after: _____
- Day 20: ☐ Silent minute Feeling after: _____
- Day 21: ☐ 4-7-8 breathing Feeling after: _____
- Day 22: ☐ Body scan before sleep Feeling after: _____
- Day 23: ☐ Mindful eating (full meal) Feeling after: _____
- Day 24: ☐ Nature walk Feeling after: _____
- Day 25: ☐ Compliment mindfully Feeling after: _____
- Day 26: ☐ Breathing before test Feeling after: _____
- Day 27: ☐ Loving-kindness (all) Feeling after: _____
- Day 28: ☐ Mindful stretching Feeling after: _____
- Day 29: ☐ Gratitude jar entry Feeling after: _____
- Day 30: ☐ Full 10-min meditation Feeling after: _____

MINDFULNESS MASTER CERTIFICATE

Awarded to:

For completing this entire book!

Date: _____

Author: Daniel Tesfamariam

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Date: _____

Today I learned:

How I will use this:

My goal for tomorrow:

Free writing space:

[illegible]

Date: _____

Today I learned:

How I will use this:

My goal for tomorrow:

Free writing space:

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Date. _____

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Date: _____

Today I learned:

How I will use this:

My goal for tomorrow:

Free writing space:

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

CHALLENGE:

Think of 3 new ideas related to this topic and explain each one.

My Work:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

Create a mind map connecting everything you learned.

My Work:

[illegible]

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

Write a letter explaining this topic to a younger child.

My Work:

[illegible]

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

Design a poster that teaches the most important concept.

My Work:

[illegible]

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

List 10 questions you still have about this topic.

My Work:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

Draw a comic strip showing what you learned in action.

My Work:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

Write 5 ways you can apply this knowledge in real life.

My Work:

[illegible]

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

Create a quiz for a friend (with answer key!).

My Work:

[illegible]

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

Compare and contrast two concepts from this book.

My Work:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CREATIVE SPACE: MINDFULNESS

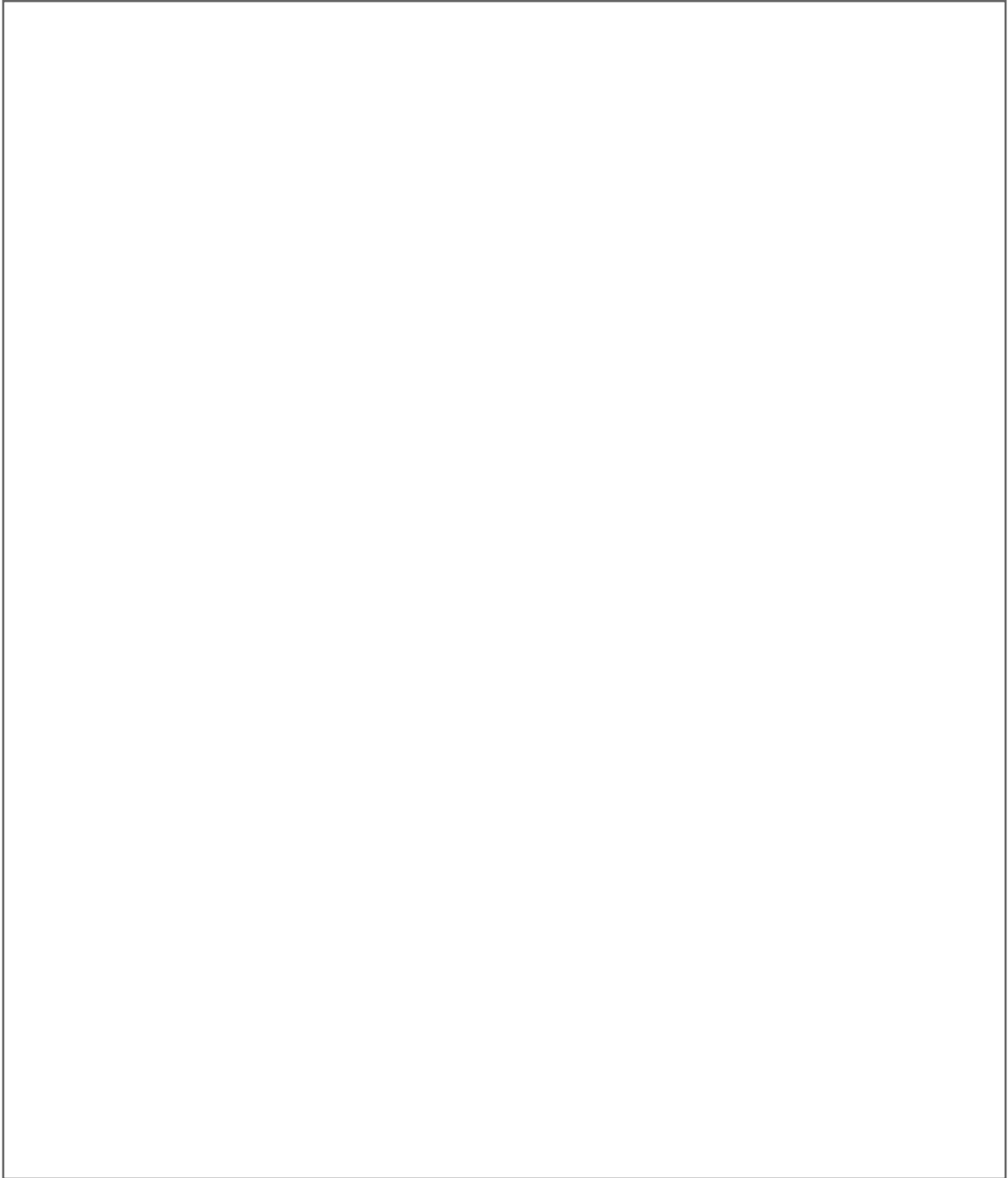
Draw what you learned today

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin black border, occupying the central portion of the page. It is intended for a student to draw or write their response to the prompt above.

Use this space for drawing, writing, or brainstorming!

CREATIVE SPACE: MINDFULNESS

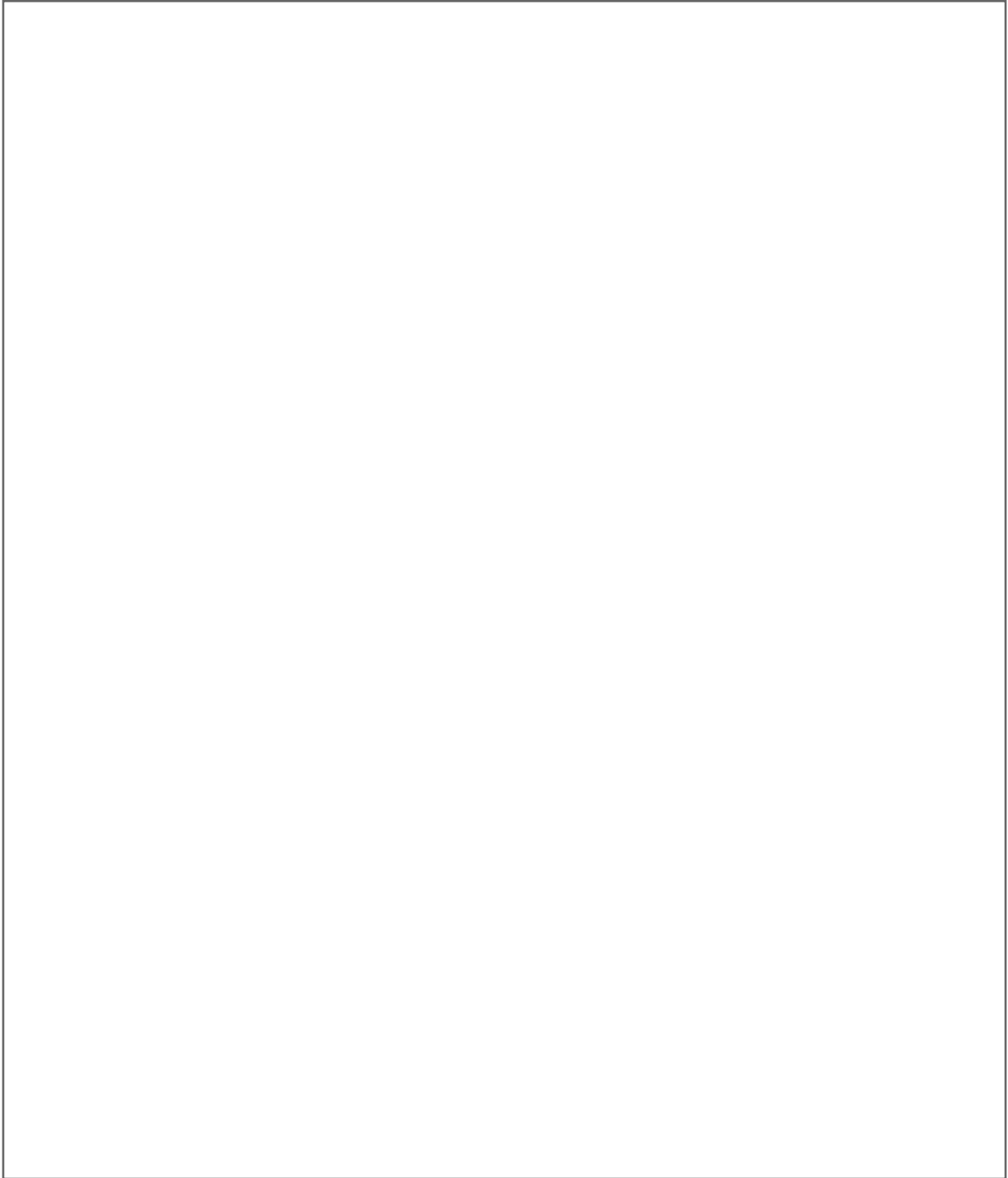
Illustrate your favorite concept

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin black border, occupying the central portion of the page. It is intended for the user to illustrate their favorite concept related to mindfulness.

Use this space for drawing, writing, or brainstorming!

CREATIVE SPACE: MINDFULNESS

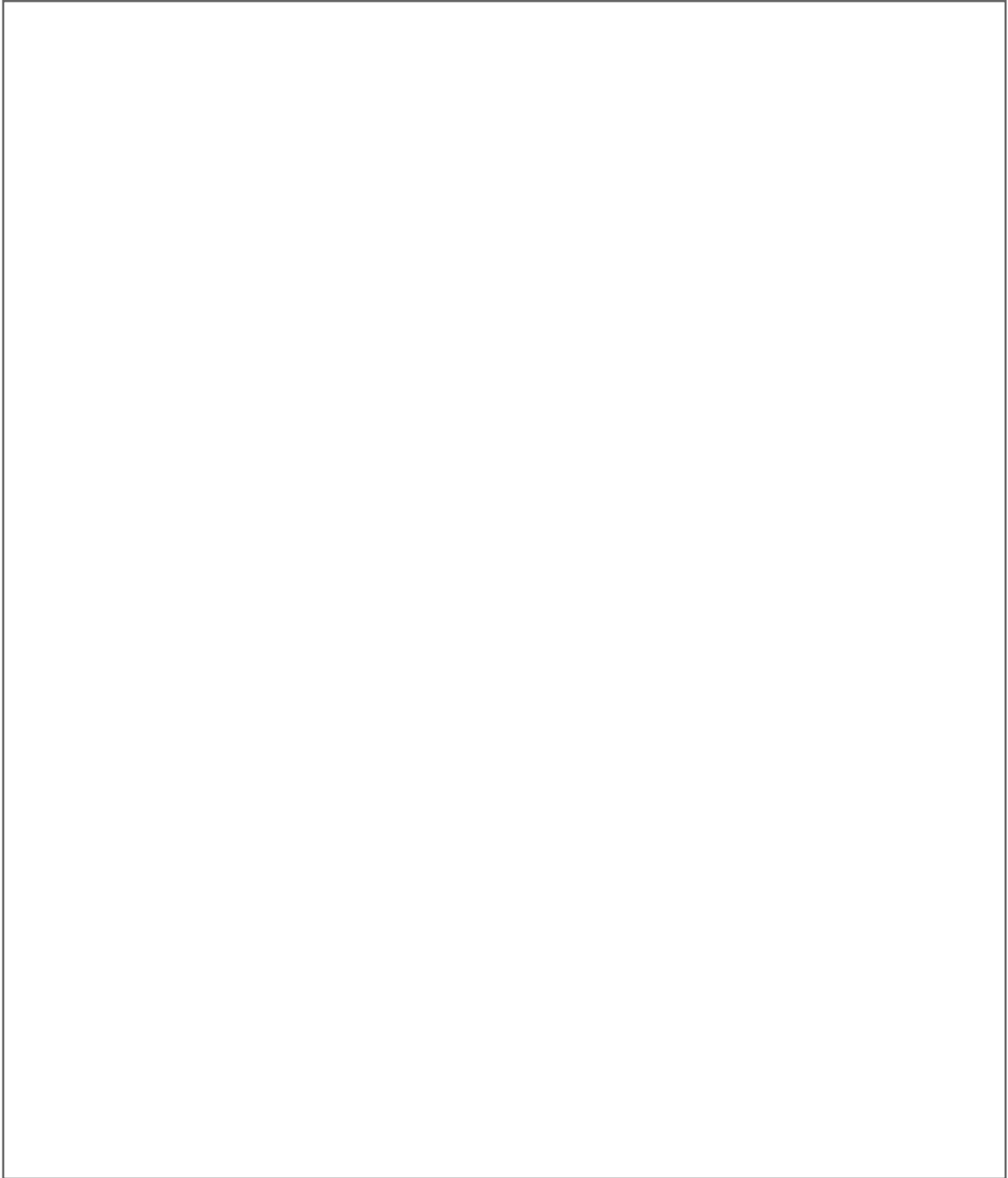
Create a visual summary of this chapter

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin black border, intended for a visual summary, drawing, or brainstorming activity.

Use this space for drawing, writing, or brainstorming!

CREATIVE SPACE: MINDFULNESS

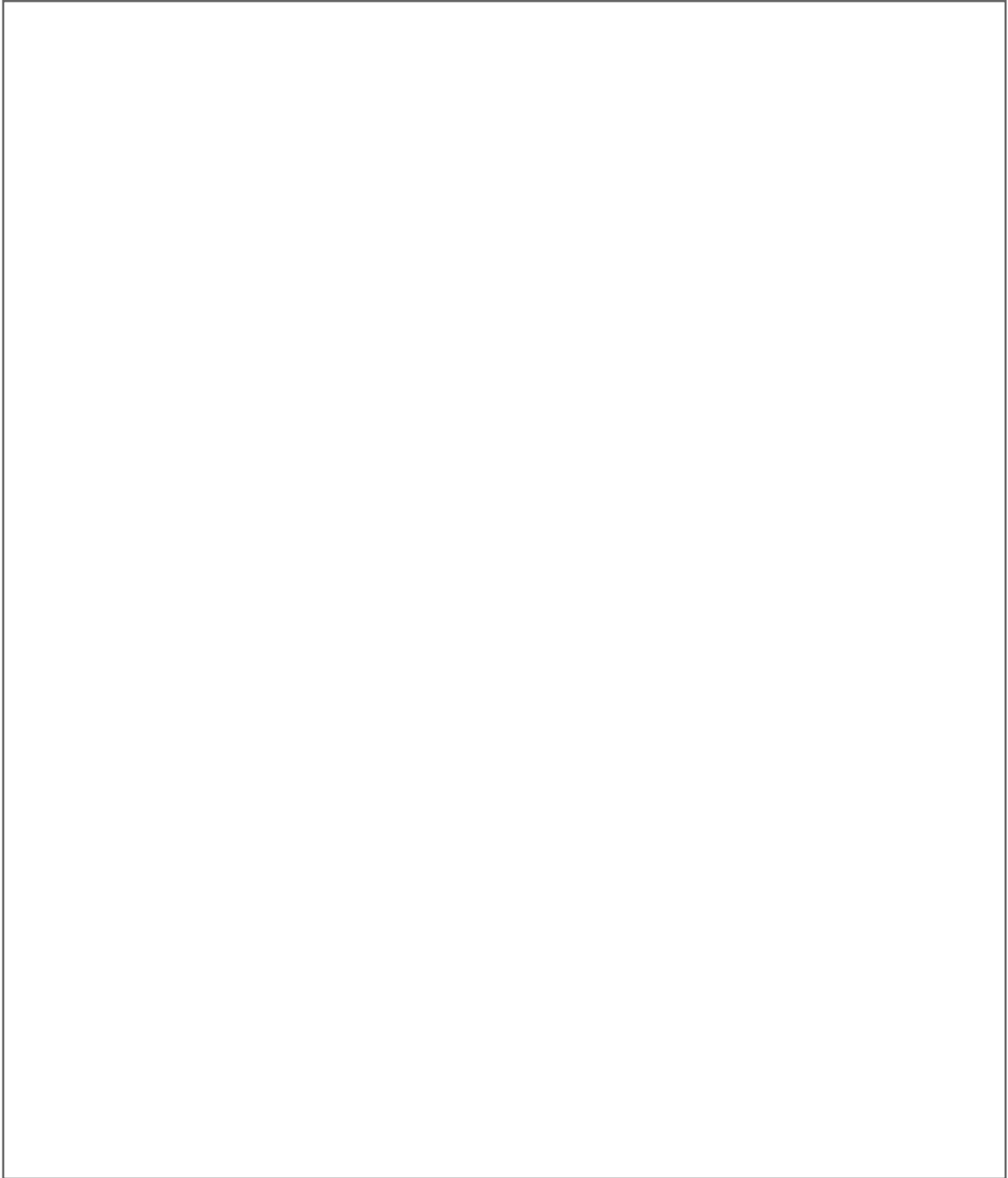
Draw yourself using this knowledge

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin black border, occupying the central portion of the page. It is intended for drawing, writing, or brainstorming.

Use this space for drawing, writing, or brainstorming!

CREATIVE SPACE: MINDFULNESS

Design a symbol that represents this topic

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin black border, intended for a student to draw a symbol or write about mindfulness.

Use this space for drawing, writing, or brainstorming!

CREATIVE SPACE: MINDFULNESS

Sketch your goals

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin black border, occupying the central portion of the page. It is intended for sketching goals, as indicated by the text above it.

Use this space for drawing, writing, or brainstorming!

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 20 evenly spaced horizontal grey lines across the entire width of the page, providing a guide for writing. The background is a solid off-white color. There are no margins, text, or other markings present.

[illegible]

[illegible]

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[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]